



Dark Souls board game

The new Dark Souls: The Board Game is an innovative multiplayer which fans of the genre will definitely appreciate. Priced \$120. <http://dgit.in/DarkBoard>



PUBG surpasses Dota 2

PLAYERUNKNOWN'S BATTLEGROUNDS has surpassed Dota 2 to be the all-time highest played game on Steam. <http://dgit.in/PUBGdota>

work to get done, which IBM gladly obliged. When the last decade of the century came around, lots of companies were aping IBM due to them using an Intel 8088 processor and was basically a very open approach to architecture which ended up lending itself well to being copied. Meanwhile, Apple used a Motorola 68000 processor and a closed off approach to architecture and typically browbeat anyone who tried to copy it with lawsuits. This resulted in software designed for these IBM machines running DOS being practically everywhere, with only a small niche using Macintoshes. The thing about DOS is that, even though there were several variants floating around, software written for one version would usually run on another. A lot of marketing and deals later, Microsoft ended up making software for both IBM AND its clones (such as Compaq) resulting in Microsoft's stellar rise from a small time software vendor to a huge player in the market. Their main competitor at this time was DR-DOS, developed by a company called Digital Research. Microsoft managed to vanquish Digital Research through a rather ingenious tactic – they hyped the subsequent releases of MS-DOS as much as they could. The possibility that this new version of MS-DOS might be incompatible with DR-DOS worried businesses. Since most of them were running on MS-DOS already, even people who were going to switch to DR-DOS decided to “wait and watch”, and thereby starving sales to Digital Research. This slowly solidified Microsoft's lead until it was a sort of monopoly over the whole PC market. A lot of people believe that this monopoly lead to an overall slump in innovation within the company in later years, until Anti-Trust laws forced them to change. (The detailed history and the sequence of events is fascinating: <http://dgit.in/moreonms>)

This monopoly also had the effect of growing that festering hate in the community. Added to the fact that Microsoft started charging rather high amounts of money for their software (Once again the keyword is monopoly),

literally any and every single move by them was termed as a cash grab, even though in actuality it might have been priced fairly. But yes, Microsoft was a huge market meanie and potentially slowed down the growth that healthy competition brings.



This little snippet of code written on a piece of paper costs anywhere from \$150 to \$450

THE MODERN ERA (A.K.A PART WHERE THE MILLENNIALS CAN RELATE)

Then came the turn of the century and Microsoft ended up doing pretty well for itself. But no matter how many things they seemed to get right (Windows 2000 and XP anyone?) any small misstep (or rather blunder) by them was met with a disproportionate amount of hostility – more than any other company would've received in a similar setting. The amount of hate and vitriol after releases of Windows Me or Vista was exponentially greater than the hate Apple released for a release like OS X Lion. But more often than not, Microsoft usually ends up delivering good products but the hate still remains. This is sort of reminiscent of the famous monkey experiment in which new entrants to a culture just blindly follow what previous generations learn/teach without knowing the reasons themselves. (read about the experiment: <http://dgit.in/mkyseemkydo>)

Are people today just hating on Microsoft with no precise reason or is it just cool to rag on M\$? What happened to people who cheered it on when it was the underdog back in its infancy? Is it basically “You either die a hero or live long enough to see yourself turn into the villain”? Perhaps this targeted hate is a cycle. Underdogs get cheered on un-

til they rise to the top and then slowly discordant murmurs start and those mutate into dislike and eventually hate. Look at OnePlus for example – they're just hitting the discordant murmurs part with the ‘high’ price tag on the OnePlus 5 and the recent benchmark cheating fiasco. While just a couple of years ago, OnePlus was treated as the second coming. Or perhaps people hate Microsoft to ease their conscience when they install a pirated version of Windows, telling themselves “Pshht, 7k for Windows 10 when it's practically free on PirateBay? Effing money grab! M\$ doesn't need my money, they're already rich so I'm going to stick it to the man!”.

Or is the hate justified? Microsoft still isn't exactly unblemished. Subreddits are rife with strong opinions about how the company allegedly still hates Linux despite making it appear like they are embracing it publicly. Plus at a product level, Windows can be extremely annoying – what with forced / untimely update downloads and ads on their flagship OS offering; not to mention the extremely spooky daily pinging of the telemetry server, in which all manner of data is routinely sent to Microsoft (<http://dgit.in/mtelemetry>). Additionally, your computer might be used as a node to let other computers download Windows updates from you. Any one of these is enough to sway public opinion from ‘Hey, this is a good product’ to ‘Damn you M\$’.

But we'll stop listing these niggles at this point, lest you start thinking of this as a “hit piece”. For the record, it's not. These kind of annoyances are found on any platform and with any technology giant or its ecosystem. The point of this exercise was to explore the rationality (or maybe even irrationality) behind some of the most deeply held sentiments we hold as consumers. Fanboys will obviously be firing up their hate mail generators at us – and we welcome those whole-heartedly – but the real goal was to give you some food for thought. Does Microsoft really suck anymore? Or maybe it's time we dropped the M\$ and just evaluate MS through a new lens. A Hololens, perhaps?